

Bogdan Balikhin

Data Architect and Data Engineering Leader

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Remote. Russian companies: employment under Russian labour law or a Russian sole proprietorship (preferred).
International companies: B2B through an Armenian sole proprietorship. Available for client working hours.

Professional Profile

Data architect and engineering leader with 15+ years across software development, architecture and technical leadership. Progressed from systems administration to Head of IT at a large retail company before moving into enterprise software development. Built and developed cross-functional teams while combining people management, architecture and hands-on engineering. Deep expertise in data platforms, warehouses, databases and performance, supported by broad experience across the software lifecycle, from business requirements to production operations. Domains include financial services, healthcare, AdTech, retail and education analytics.

Target Roles

Data Architect / Data Platform Architect / DWH Architect;
Engineering Manager - Data / Data Engineering Manager / Head of Data Engineering;
Lead / Principal Data Engineer.

Core Capabilities

- Architecture: Azure/AWS data platforms, warehouses and lakehouses, data modelling, batch/streaming, integrations and API contracts, phased legacy modernisation.
- Leadership: team building, senior engineering recruitment, mentoring, 1:1s, performance reviews, delegation, backlog prioritisation and delivery/quality metrics.
- Engineering quality: architecture and code reviews, performance optimisation, data quality, governance, lineage, MDM and sensitive-data protection.

Professional Experience

JayDevs | Senior Data Engineer | 05.2026–Present

- Build a banking data platform using Azure Event Hubs/Kafka, Spark/PySpark, Airflow, Iceberg and ClickHouse, combining streaming ingestion and analytical processing.
- Implement REST and nested JSON ingestion, schema evolution, quality checks and replayable processing. Optimise SQL and data layouts and contribute to architecture decisions and cross-team reviews.

Access Softek Inc. | Technical Product Manager | 06.2025–04.2026 (1 year)

- Owned the roadmap, backlog and priorities for bank core integrations; aligned requirements and dependencies across engineering, implementation and business stakeholders within a SAFe organisation.
- Restored predictable delivery against iteration goals, stabilised the team and supported hiring and onboarding. Reduced incidents through improved error handling and diagnostics.
- Advanced a Unified Canonical API across Symitar, DNA, Keystone, Datasafe, including SOAP-to-REST modernisation; improved card-data masking in logs.

Nuvm / 340Basics | Team Lead DBA / Data Engineering | 11.2018–02.2025 (6½ years)

- Built and developed the data function across DBA, database development, data engineering, DevOps and BI/analytics. Hired and mentored specialists, conducted 1:1s and performance reviews, and delegated technical coordination to senior engineers.
- Combined team leadership, data architecture and Data Product Owner responsibilities. Translated business needs into data models, backlog and roadmap; owned priorities, delivery and production reliability.
- Led migration of a SQL Server warehouse to Azure Synapse Dedicated SQL Pool. Implemented incremental ingestion with ADF and Change Tracking, idempotent ETL and streaming processing with Azure Functions.
- Introduced ADLS Gen2/Parquet archiving and began the move towards Delta Lake/lakehouse. Evaluated Cosmos DB for flexible customer JSON ingestion in an MVP, including partitioning and RU cost trade-offs.
- Developed data quality, governance, lineage and MDM practices; worked with X12/HL7 and a .NET parser, and implemented PHI masking. Used Terraform/ARM for infrastructure.
- Secured adoption of shared standards by application, BI and outsourcing teams through joint architecture/code reviews. Used incident and performance evidence to agree changes and resolve inefficient SQL and data-access designs before production.

SolarLab | Business / System Analyst | 11.2017–11.2018 (1 year)

- Analysed business requirements. Designed API contracts and solutions for blockchain wallets and payments, and a ClickHouse warehouse.

Shakuro | Data Architect | 11.2016–11.2017 (1 year)

- Recruited data engineers and built and led the team. Prioritised the backlog and maintained regular stakeholder communication to align technical delivery with business needs.
- Designed an AWS platform spanning Python, MongoDB, PostgreSQL and Redshift, with Talend and Tableau. Independently provisioned, configured and administered databases; built pipelines with a data engineer and optimised models and queries.

AdoTube / Exponential | Lead Data Engineer / DBA | 06.2013–11.2016 (3½ years)

- Developed and operated AdTech infrastructure processing approximately 10–15 billion events per day. Evolved Hadoop/MapReduce towards Spark, Hive and Impala, working with AWS/EMR.
- Worked on processing performance and operational stability across data workloads, MySQL and Redis; developed batch and incremental processing.

SoftServe | Team Lead DB / ETL, DBA | 08.2010–03.2013 (2½ years)

- Built and managed two teams in parallel on separate projects: a banking team of DBAs, database developers and BI specialists, and an academic performance analytics team of data engineers and QA specialists.
- Factoring Back Office: led SQL Server database development and contributed to .NET/Oracle ESB integrations, warehouse design, SSIS pipelines and database CI/CD.
- Pearson Prevent: led ETL development and MySQL administration, building integrations with Talend. Conducted technical reviews and supported solution quality and reliability.

Maximum Ltd | Head of IT | 11.2006–07.2010 (3¾ years)

- Defined the engineering vision and long-term IT infrastructure roadmap for a large retail company, aligning technology development with business requirements.
- Recruited and mentored systems administrators and DBAs; led IT operations, vendor coordination and technical changes.

Technologies and Methods

Cloud: Azure: Synapse, ADF, ADLS Gen2, Functions, Event Hubs. AWS: S3, EMR, Redshift, Glue, Lambda, Athena, RDS/Aurora. Terraform/ARM.

Processing and storage: Spark/PySpark, Spark SQL, Hadoop, Hive/Impala, Kafka, Debezium CDC, Airflow, Dagster, SSIS; Delta Lake, Iceberg, Parquet.

Databases: SQL Server, Azure Synapse, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redshift, ClickHouse, Greenplum, MongoDB, Redis, Cosmos DB.

Modelling: Kimball, Inmon, Data Vault 2.0, Anchor, Star/Snowflake, SCD, MDM; governance, data quality, lineage.

Development and BI: SQL, T-SQL, PL/pgSQL, Python, Bash; Power BI, Tableau, Superset, Looker, Great Expectations.

Basic familiarity: Snowflake, BigQuery, dbt, MLflow.

Delivery and management: Agile, Scrum, Kanban, SAFe; Waterfall and hybrid models.

Prioritisation: WSJF, RICE, MoSCoW, KANO.

Planning and governance: roadmap, capacity, dependency and risk management, OKRs/KPIs. Metrics and improvement: DORA, lead time, cycle time, throughput, predictability, Theory of Constraints; Cynefin for complex situations.

Education and Languages

National Technical University — Specialist degree (Bachelor+), Semiconductor Devices and Microelectronics.

English: B2–C1 | Russian